[METRIC]
A-A-2837
August 20, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

NAPKINS, PAPER, DINNER, THREE-PLY

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all Federal agencies.

1. **SCOPE.** This Commercial Item Description covers white, three-ply, eighth-folded, paper dinner napkins.

2. **SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.**

2.1 **Material.** Napkins furnished under this description shall contain not less than 30 percent postconsumer recovered materials, as defined by 40 CFR Part 250.

2.2 **Workmanship.** The napkins shall be clean and free of holes, tears, wrinkles, dirt or foreign particles that adversely affect appearance or serviceability. There shall be no visible clumps of undispersed fibers or thin looking areas in the napkin. The napkins shall be square cut with clean, smooth edges without raggedness.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza New York, N.Y. 10278.

Distribution Statement A:
Approved for public release;
Distribution is unlimited.

FSC 8540

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.3 Physical Requirements.

TABLE I

CHARACTERISTIC	REQUIREMENT	TEST METHOD
Basis Weight g/m2 (lbs, 24 X 36-500) min.	49 (30)	T 410
Absorption Time, sec., max.	100	T 432
Brightness, percent, min.	76	T 452

2.4 Style and Dimensions. Napkins shall be three-ply and eighth-folded. When unfolded, the napkin shall comply with the following dimensions:

Area - 0.175 sq. meter (272 sq.inch) minimum
Length - 40.6 cm (16 inch) minimum
Width - 40.6 cm (16 inch) minimum

2.5 General Requirements.

2.5.1 Odor. Napkins shall have no disagreeable odor, either wet or dry.

2.5.2 Color. Napkins shall be white and of uniform color.

2.5.3 Finish. Napkins shall be creped or embossed.

3. Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness, or color, in accordance with this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified (see Paragraph 7) the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, hypochlorite, or other chlorine containing compound. Certification of compliance shall be made available upon request by the Government.

4. Regulatory Requirements. The contractor shall certify that the napkins offered shall include a minimum of 30% postconsumer recovered materials in accordance with CFR 40 Part 250. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. Quality Assurance Provisions. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all the inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the contractor may utilize his own facilities or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this Commercial Item Description, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the plans specified in Table II, unless otherwise stated. For the purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all napkins submitted for inspection at one time. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for the end item inspection. Unless otherwise specified, every lot shall be tested.

For preparation for delivery examination, the sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container. For all other examinations, the sample unit shall be one napkin, unless specified otherwise.

TABLE II

Examine	Inspection Level	AQL (% defect)/ Acceptance
Workmanship/ General	S-3	4.0
Dimensional/Style	S-4	2.5
Preparation for delivery	S-2	2.5
Physical Properties *	per Tappi	per Tappi

*Brightness shall be tested on the paper itself; all other properties shall be tested on the end item napkin.

6. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS AND DOCUMENT SOURCES. The following documents form a part of this Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

6.1 TAPPI Standards.

T 402 Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres for Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets and Related Products
T 410 Grammage of Paper and Paperboard(Weight per Unit Area)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

T 432 Water Absorbency of Bibulous Papers
T 452 Brightness of Pulp, Paper and Paperboard (Directional Reflectance at 457 nm)

Copies of Tappi Standards are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, PO Box 105113, Atlanta, Ga 30348.

6.2 Federal Standards.

Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, Handbooks, and Commercial Item Descriptions (CIDs), as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

Single copies of Commercial Item Descriptions, federal standards or specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Philadelphia; Washington, D. C.; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; For Worth; Houston; Denver; Los Angeles; San Francisco; and Auburn, WA. They may also be obtained from: GSA Specifications Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D Streets S.W., Washington, DC 20407.

6.3 Military Standards.

MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

6.4 Code of Federal Regulations, Title 40, Protection of Environment.

Part 250, Guideline for Federal Procurement of Paper and Paper Products containing Recovered Materials. Copies of the U.S. Code of Federal Regulations may be purchased with a VISA, Master Card, or prepaid check through:
Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402
Phone (202) 783-3238

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

When ordering, ask for:
Title 40, Parts 190-250
Stock Number: 869-013-00-146-0

7. Notes.

A. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(1) Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
(2) Packaging, packing and marking
(3) Dimensions
(4) Bleaching (see Paragraph 3)

B. Supersession Data.
CID A-A-2837 replaces Interim Federal Specification UU-N- 001650B, dated May 5, 1978, Type I.

MILITARY INTEREST:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.